

Caves, Hidden Caves & Their Bosses

A traveller's guide to the depths of Avelune

How to find every descent, what each seal wants, who guards it, and what you can carry out -
including gifts worthy of the seven.

How caves work

Dungeon mouths are stone arches with a stair going down. Touch one with E. If you have no rumour about it yet, the stones teach you the rumour on the spot ("Clue found") and the blue seal-ring lights. Quests, the gold compass star and the rose beacon always point at your current descent.

Hidden caves stay off the realm map until you have actually been inside - unless a quest sends you. The mouth arch itself is always out there for anyone who walks the wilds with open eyes.

Inside: read the stele, answer what the room asks (force never works), take the reward, and mind the guardian. Every depth below has a boss with a shockwave slam and a skull bar. Bring heroines - they fight beside you, share all experience, and never truly fall.

Boss rewards are gifts too

Emberbrand, Rimecloak, Briar Charm and the Ember Bell are keepsakes as well as gear: equip them for their strength, or offer them to a heroine from the gift choice when you talk. (+3 bond. She keeps it. That is what keeping means.)

1. Gloam Cavern (hidden cave)

Where: East of Whisperwood Ruin, about 750 paces east of the chiselled mural (-1156, 802).

Rumour: Walk the ruin (within sight of the mural) or touch the mouth itself.

Puzzle: Seven candles, one snuffed on purpose. The stele asks: count only what still burns.

Answer: Answer: Six. Something heavy turns over in the rock.

Boss: Gloam Mother - a brooding mass with spikes. Melee, no manners.

Reward: The Ember Bell (charm, +3 guard) - rings warm near the Choir. Giftable.

2. The Gravespine Vault (hidden cave)

Where: Gravespine foothills, ~1.3 km north of Lullwater Port along the coast (2650, -1500). Sail there, then walk.

Rumour: Work the Lullwater docks, or touch the mouth itself.

Puzzle: Three bells, two split down the side. The vault asks to be rung.

Answer: Ring the middle bell - the one that still sings. The cracked ones only knock.

Boss: Warden Effigy - a brass guardian that shoots back. Ranged.

Reward: The Warden's Sigil - opens the deep wards under Veilmoon Tarn. Quest-critical; do not lose it.

3. Veilmoon Depths (the sealed girl)

Where: Far north, past the grey hills, at the north end of still black Veilmoon Tarn (-1100, -4180).

Rumour: Visit the Tarn. Then bring the Warden's Sigil.

Puzzle: Six pedestals lit. The seventh holds a girl with blue blooms, eyes open, eleven years waiting.

Answer: Do NOT strike the seal - it drinks force. Speak through it, then lean in and give the breath back.

Boss: Choir Herald - a flying wraith that guards the seals. Ranged, with a shockwave.

Reward: Liora Vaine herself. She travels with you from that breath on. (Her ??? becomes a name.)

4. Emberdeep Vault (side descent, optional)

Where: In the caldera rocks west of Emberfall Hold (2529, 1829). Follow the heat.

Rumour: Visit Emberfall Hold; the forge-folk talk.

Puzzle: Bells again - the deep loves bells. Same courtesy: ring what still sings.

Answer: The unbroken bell.

Boss: Cinder Matriarch - a drake wreathed in ember, ranged fire. Big, proud, flammable temper.

Reward: Emberbrand - greatsword, +9 strike. Equip it or gift it.

5. The Rimed Crypt (side descent, optional)

Where: A white door in the high mountain col (-300, 1800). Cold with a posture.

Rumour: Visit the Cinder Chapel; the monks watch the white peaks.

Puzzle: Candles and a question, as below: count only what still burns.

Answer: Six.

Boss: Rime Tyrant - tall, pale, unhurried. Melee that numbs.

Reward: Rimecloak - armour, +7 guard, never cold. Equip it or gift it.

6. Thornhollow (side descent, optional)

Where: A grove east of Whisperwood Ruin (-1400, 1300). Roots like bars.

Rumour: Walk Whisperwood; the grove is local gossip.

Puzzle: Bells among thorns. Ring what still sings.

Answer: The unbroken bell.

Boss: Thorn Regent - a walking briar throne. Melee, prickly in every sense.

Reward: Briar Charm - charm, +4 guard. Equip it or gift it.